

Norway’s Exports to the U.S., and What the New Tariff Puts at Stake

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A short applied data-analysis case study

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Background

In late July 2026, the United States imposed an additional 12.5% tariff on Norwegian goods, replacing the temporary 10% global tariff that expired on 24 July 2026. The U.S. justified the higher rate under a Section 301 investigation into forced labour in global supply chains. The Norwegian government has publicly rejected that justification.¹

The OECD’s 2026 Economic Survey of Norway characterizes the country as relatively insulated from U.S. trade policy, since the U.S. takes well under 4% of Norway’s total exports.² The numbers below sit inside that picture. While aggregate exposure is low, some industries will, naturally, have greater exposure than others.

The tariff is barely a month old at the time of writing, and SSB’s trade statistics lag by about a month. There is not yet any meaningful *post-tariff* data to analyse. Instead of forcing a before/after analysis with lacking data, this case study aims at answering the following questions:

1. **How much**, and in which industries, does Norway export to the U.S., and how dependent is each industry on that specific market?
2. **How stable is that trade normally**, seasonally and otherwise, before any policy shock, so a future change can be judged against a real baseline?
3. **How much is actually at stake**: will this new tariff account for meaningful change in exports?

Data

Source: Statistics Norway (SSB), StatBank Table [08806, External trade in goods, by commodity group, country, month and imports/exports](#). Data are licensed under [CC BY 4.0](#).

Industries are classified using the UN’s [Standard International Trade Classification \(SITC\)](#) at the 1-digit level. This is broad enough to read at a glance and granular enough to show which sectors are exposed to the tariff.

Three SSB extracts, same commodity/exports settings, differing in country and time span, plus one exchange rate series pulled live:

File	Country	Months	Used for
<code>exports_us_monthly.xlsx</code>	United States	Jan 2025 to present	Main totals, share, exposure
<code>exports_total_monthly.xlsx</code>	All countries	Jan 2025 to present	US share of Norway’s total exports
<code>exports_us_monthly_long.xlsx</code>	United States	Jan 2018 to present	Seasonal baseline

The exchange rate series (NOK per USD, monthly average) is pulled directly from Norges Bank’s open data API, series `EXR/M.USD.NOK.SP`, at render time, rather than from a downloaded file. It reflects whatever Norges Bank has published as of whenever the script last ran.

Tidied in [scripts/00_helpers.R](#) (shared parsing logic) and [scripts/01_wrangle_exports.R](#), [02_wrangle_share_of_total.R](#), [03_wrangle_seasonal.R](#), [05_wrangle_exchange_rate.R](#).

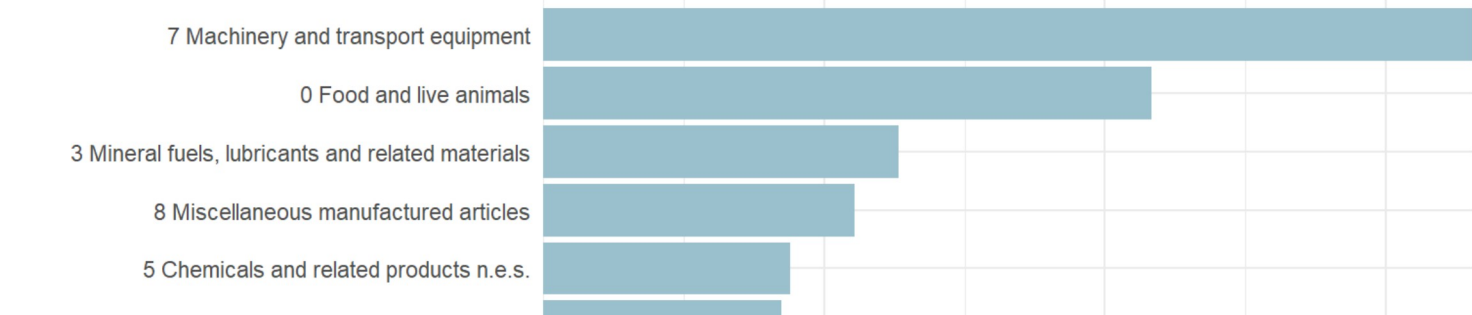
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How much does each industry export to the U.S.?

Total exports and export share, most recent 12 months, sorted by value. Although one industry may dominate Norway’s total exports to the US, it doesn’t necessarily have a correspondingly large exposure to the US market. More on this below.

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Norway's exports to the U.S., by industry



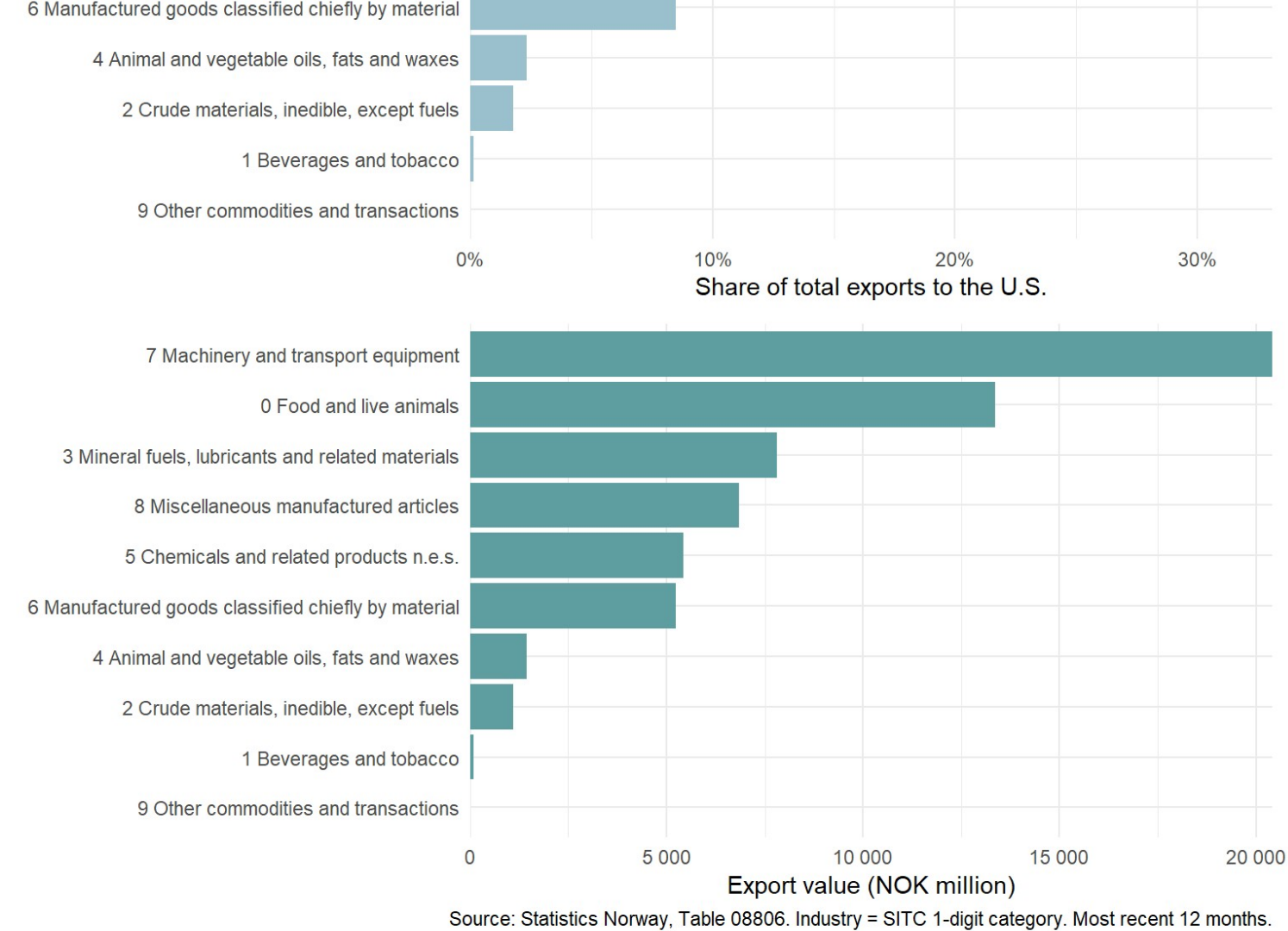


Figure 1: Norway’s exports to the U.S. by industry: value and share, most recent 12 months

How dependent is each industry on the U.S. market?

A different question from the one above. Instead of “Which industry accounts for the largest share of Norwegian exports to the US?”, it is asking “What share of each industry’s total exports are going to the US?”. It is a reflection of each industry’s exposure to the US.

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How exposed is each industry to the U.S. market specifically?

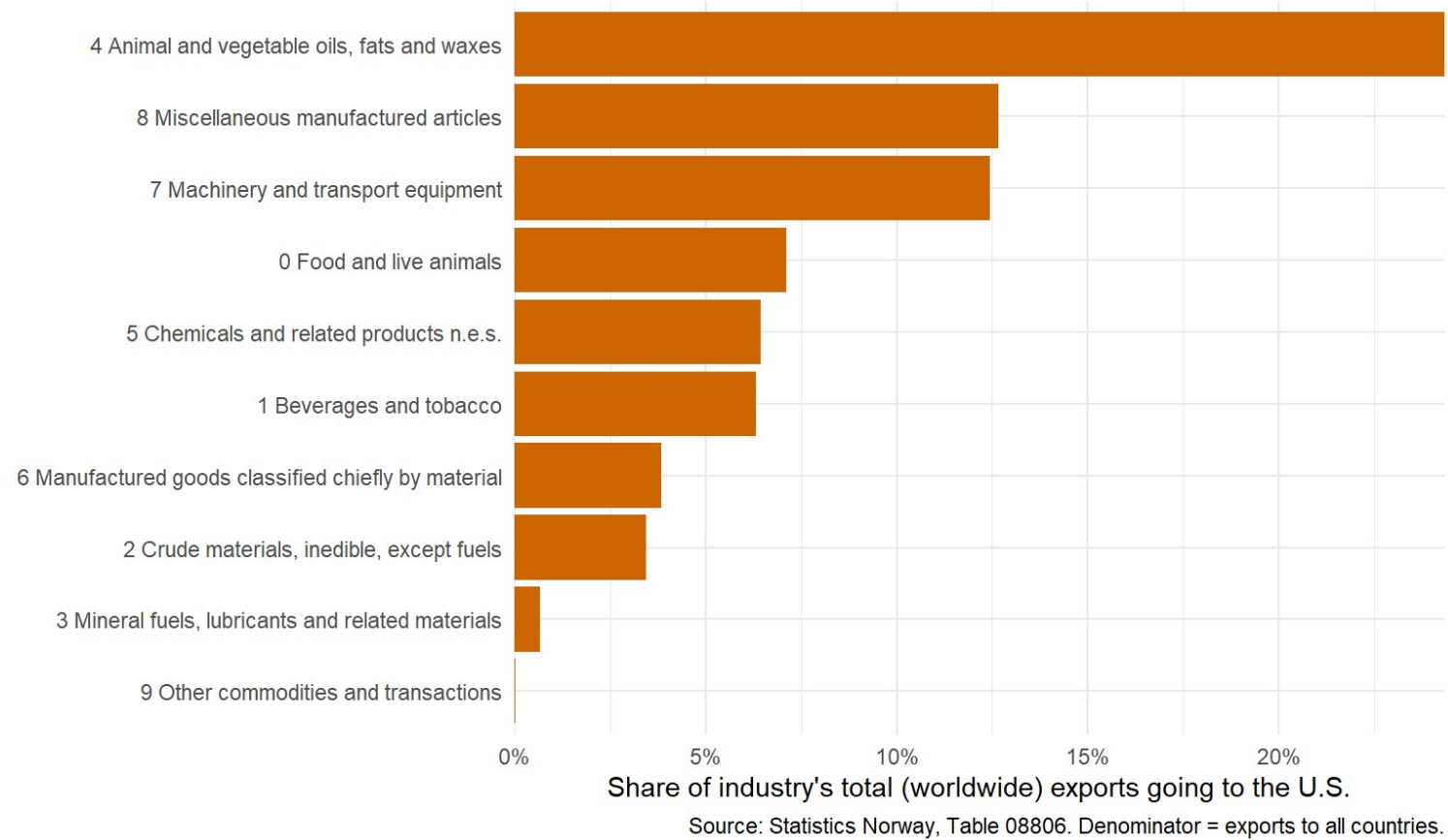


Figure 2: Share of each industry’s total (worldwide) exports that goes to the U.S., most recent 12 months

How volatile is this trade normally?

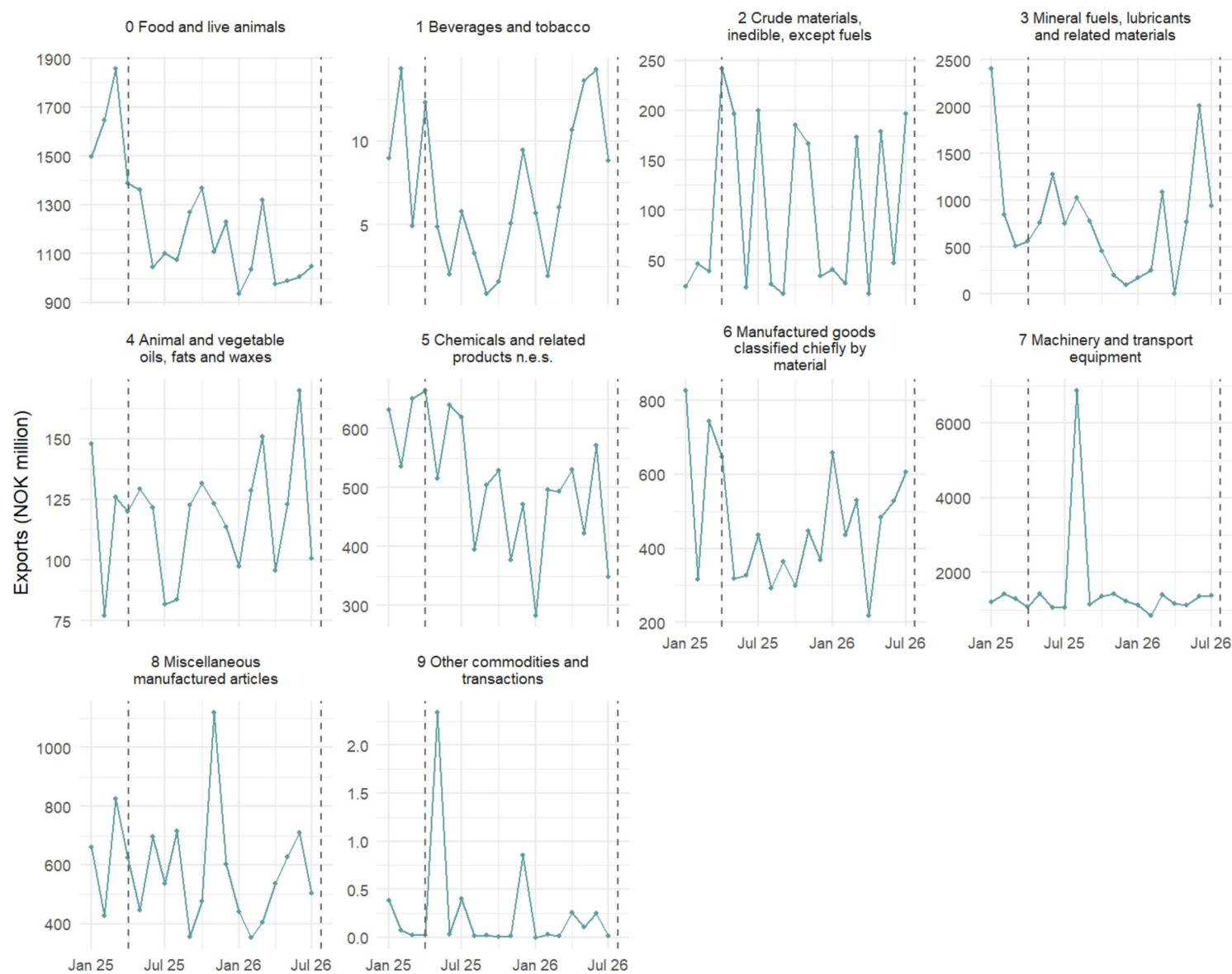
Before drawing any conclusion from a future dip or spike, a baseline for normal month-to-month variation is needed. Some industries (mineral fuels, for instance) move on large one-off shipments even with no policy change involved; others (food) are steadier.

The chart marks two dates: **2 April 2025** (“Liberation Day”), when the U.S. first announced broad reciprocal tariffs on nearly every country including Norway, and **24 July 2026**, the tariff this case study covers. The first shows what a tariff shock looks like in this data. The second has too few months of data so far for comparison.

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Norway's monthly exports to the U.S., by industry

Dashed lines: 2 Apr 2025 (Liberation Day tariffs) and 24 Jul 2026 (current tariff). Data does not yet cover a meaningful window after the second



Source: Statistics Norway, Table 08806.

Figure 3: Monthly exports to the U.S. by industry, Jan 2025 to present

A seasonally-adjusted baseline

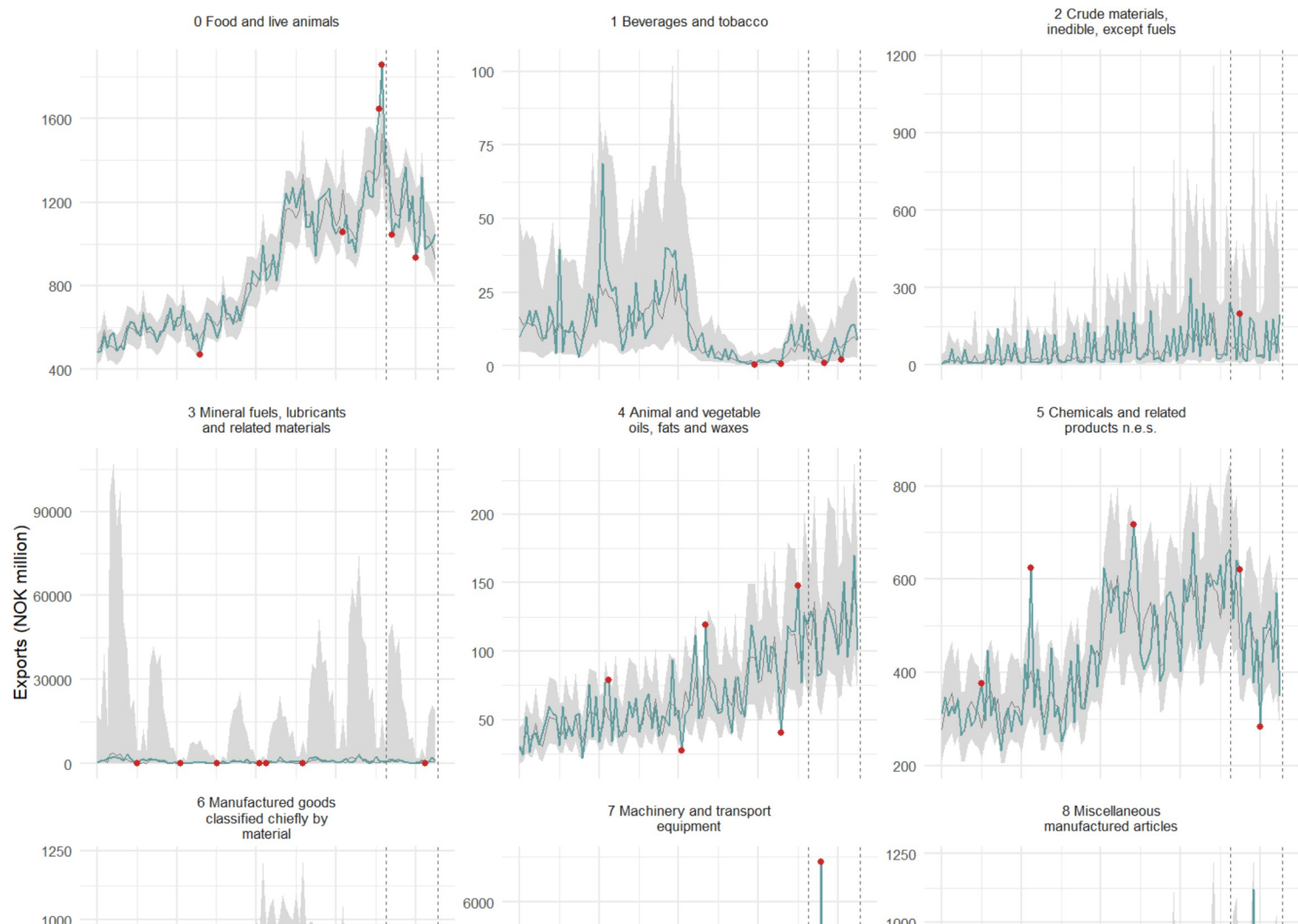
Exports naturally rise and fall by season and vary month to month for reasons that have nothing to do with policy. To judge whether a given month is actually unusual, that ordinary variation has to be removed first, leaving only the part that cannot be explained by any “normal” pattern.

Using nine years of history (2018 to present; fewer years would not support a reliable seasonal estimate), each industry’s monthly exports are decomposed via STL (Seasonal-Trend decomposition using Loess) on the log scale into trend, seasonal, and remainder components. The remainder’s historical standard deviation defines “normal”: a month is flagged as **out of the normal range** if its remainder exceeds **2 standard deviations**, larger than seasonality and typical random variation alone would usually produce. “9 Other commodities and transactions” is excluded. It is too small and irregular for a meaningful seasonal pattern.

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Actual exports vs. the seasonally-expected range

Grey band = normal range (+2 SD of remainder). Red points = out of that range. Dashed lines: Apr 2025 and Jul 2026 tariff dates.



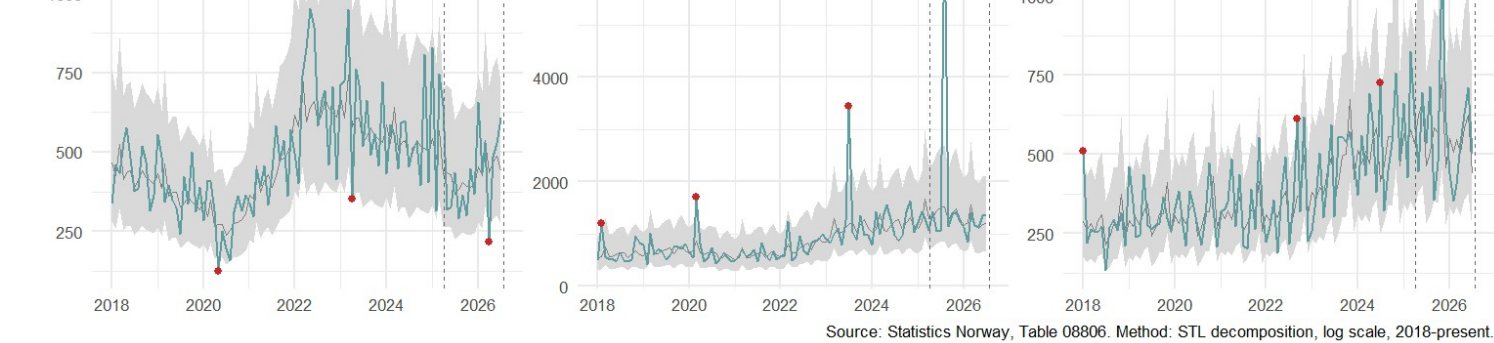


Figure 4: Actual vs. seasonally expected exports, 2018-present, with out-of-range months flagged

Keep in mind that crossing 2 standard deviations is not a claim of real-world significance, only that a month’s move is statistically larger than that industry’s typical noise. It is used here to calibrate expectations: even at the April 2025 tariff shock, only a handful of industries experienced “unusual exports”, and only “Food and live animals” in the negative direction. Most shocks do not flag every industry at once.

As stated in the introduction, there is sparse “post-tariff” data available at the time of writing (July is latest as of early September). The following table is basically a binary check of whether the latest month of data is out of normal range or not. As of today, all industries exhibit “normal” exports, but this can be used for future reference as new data is published.

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Table 1: Status of the most recent available month against each industry’s seasonal baseline

Industry	Actual (NOK mill.)	Seasonally expected (NOK mill.)	Out of normal range?
0 Food and live animals	1048	926	No
1 Beverages and tobacco	9	8	No
2 Crude materials, inedible, except fuels	197	47	No
3 Mineral fuels, lubricants and related materials	943	628	No
4 Animal and vegetable oils, fats and waxes	101	107	No
5 Chemicals and related products n.e.s.	349	366	No
6 Manufactured goods classified chiefly by material	607	443	No
7 Machinery and transport equipment	1371	1196	No
8 Miscellaneous manufactured articles	503	439	No

It is worth noting that these industries have been operating with tariffs on exports to the US ever since “Liberation Day”, lately with a 10% rate. Therefore, it is my opinion that the new 12.5% tariff replacing the old 10% tariff will not meaningfully shift export volumes. However, in a globalized economy, every competitive advantage/disadvantage can shift balances in the long run.

Controlling for the exchange rate

The tariff is not the only thing changing the price of Norwegian goods for US buyers. If the krone weakens against the dollar, Norwegian exports get cheaper in USD terms, which can offset some of the tariff’s effect. If the krone strengthens, the opposite happens, and the tariff compounds on top of an already-rising USD price.

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NOK/USD exchange rate
Dashed lines: Apr 2025 and Jul 2026 tariff dates.

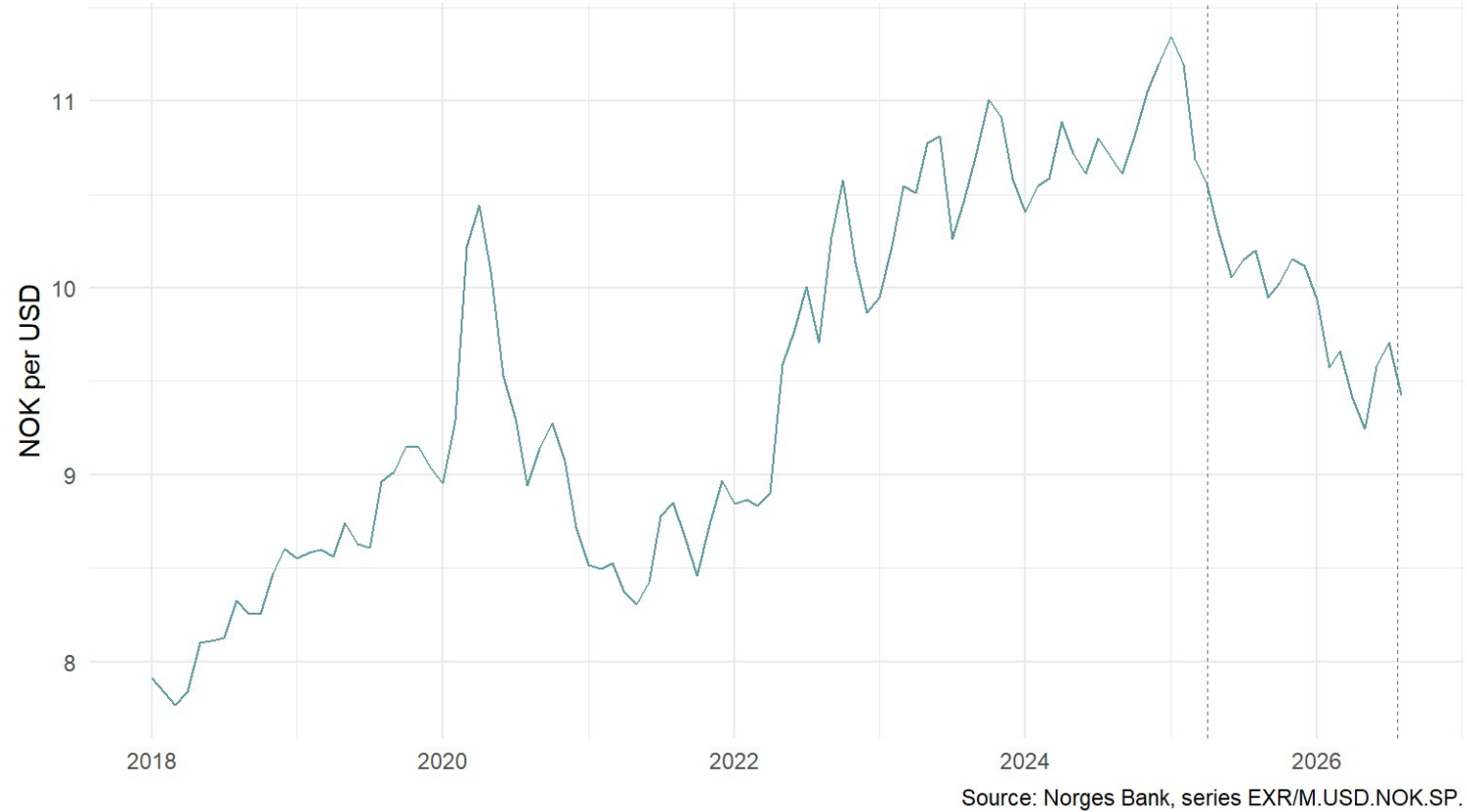


Figure 5: NOK per 1 USD, monthly average

Export to the US in 2025: A major 2025 tariff shock is expected in April 2025. Dashed lines indicate distribution of the timing and size of the shock.

From January 2025 to August 2026 (the most recent month Norges Bank had published as of when this was last run), the rate moved from 11.34 to 9.43 NOK per USD, a change of -16.9%. A falling NOK-per-USD rate means the dollar buys fewer kroner, which means the krone strengthened over this window. That works against Norwegian exporters’ USD-denominated competitiveness, independent of the tariff.

From the tariff month itself (9.71 NOK per USD) to the latest available month, the change is -2.9%. Check this figure against the chart: if the line shows no visible change in slope around 24 July 2026, the krone’s movement is a continuation of the pre-existing trend, not something the tariff appears to have triggered or interrupted.

Takeaways

Write this section once you have looked at your own rendered plots. Do not let me write your conclusions. A few honest starting points based on the structure of the data itself:

- *Machinery and transport equipment, and food, are the two largest categories. Together they likely account for a large share of total tariff exposure, simply because they are the largest exports, not because they are specially targeted.*
- *An industry can be small within the US market (low rank in fig-dependence) but still highly exposed if it has few other buyers. Check whether the two rankings, share of US market and share of own exports, actually agree.*
- *tbl-seasonal-latest gives a direct, falsifiable answer to “has anything already moved beyond normal.” Read it plainly rather than reading intent into it. One industry crossing the 2-SD line is exactly what you would expect by chance roughly 1 month in 20, tariff or not. It is a flag to watch, not a verdict.*
- *A strengthening krone works against Norwegian exporters independent of the tariff. If US-bound exports weaken later, check the exchange rate before attributing the whole move to the tariff.*

Notes on methodology

- **Units:** NOK million, current prices (not inflation-adjusted).
- **Industry classification:** SITC 1-digit, broad by design, for readability. A finer breakdown (2- or 3-digit SITC) would show whether, for example, farmed salmon specifically drives the seafood category.
- **“9 Other commodities and transactions”** is excluded from the seasonal analysis. Several months are recorded as zero or suppressed in the source data, and the category is under 0.03% of total exports (see the exposure table). It is too sparse and irregular for a seasonal pattern to be meaningful.
- **Seasonal baseline method:** STL decomposition on log-transformed monthly exports, `s.window = "periodic"` (assumes a stable seasonal pattern across the 2018-present window rather than one that drifts over time). The 2018-2021 portion includes the COVID trade disruption, which will inflate the estimated “normal” variation for some industries. A stricter baseline would exclude those years, at the cost of a shorter, noisier history to estimate from. Try both and compare if this section needs to hold up to scrutiny.
- **Why no before/after comparison of the current tariff:** it took effect 24 July 2026; at the time of writing, SSB’s most recent published month is July 2026, only partially post-tariff. A credible comparison needs several full months on each side. The seasonally-adjusted baseline above is what that future comparison should be checked against, rather than a flat pre/post average.
- **Exchange rate is pulled live, not from a static file.** The `05_wrangle_exchange_rate.R` script queries Norges Bank’s API directly at run time (series `EXR/M.USD.NOK.SP`), so August 2026 above reflects whatever was published as of the last time the pipeline ran, not a fixed download date. Re-running it later will pick up newer months automatically.
- **Reproducibility:** re-running `scripts/01_wrangle_exports.R`, `02_wrangle_share_of_total.R`, `03_wrangle_seasonal.R`, and `05_wrangle_exchange_rate.R` after downloading updated extracts regenerates every processed CSV and every figure in this document.

Footnotes

1. Norwegian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, “The US introduces a new tariff rate on goods from Norway,” 28 July 2026, <https://www.regjeringen.no/en/whats-new/the-us-introduces-a-new-tariff-rate-on-goods-from-norway/id3169293/>. ↵
2. OECD, *OECD Economic Surveys: Norway 2026*, “Preparing for long-term challenges,” https://www.oecd.org/en/publications/oecd-economic-surveys-norway-2026_5cc02644-en/full-report/preparing-for-long-term-challenges_b3a8411e.html. ↵